

Class 7

Land, Rails, and the National Market

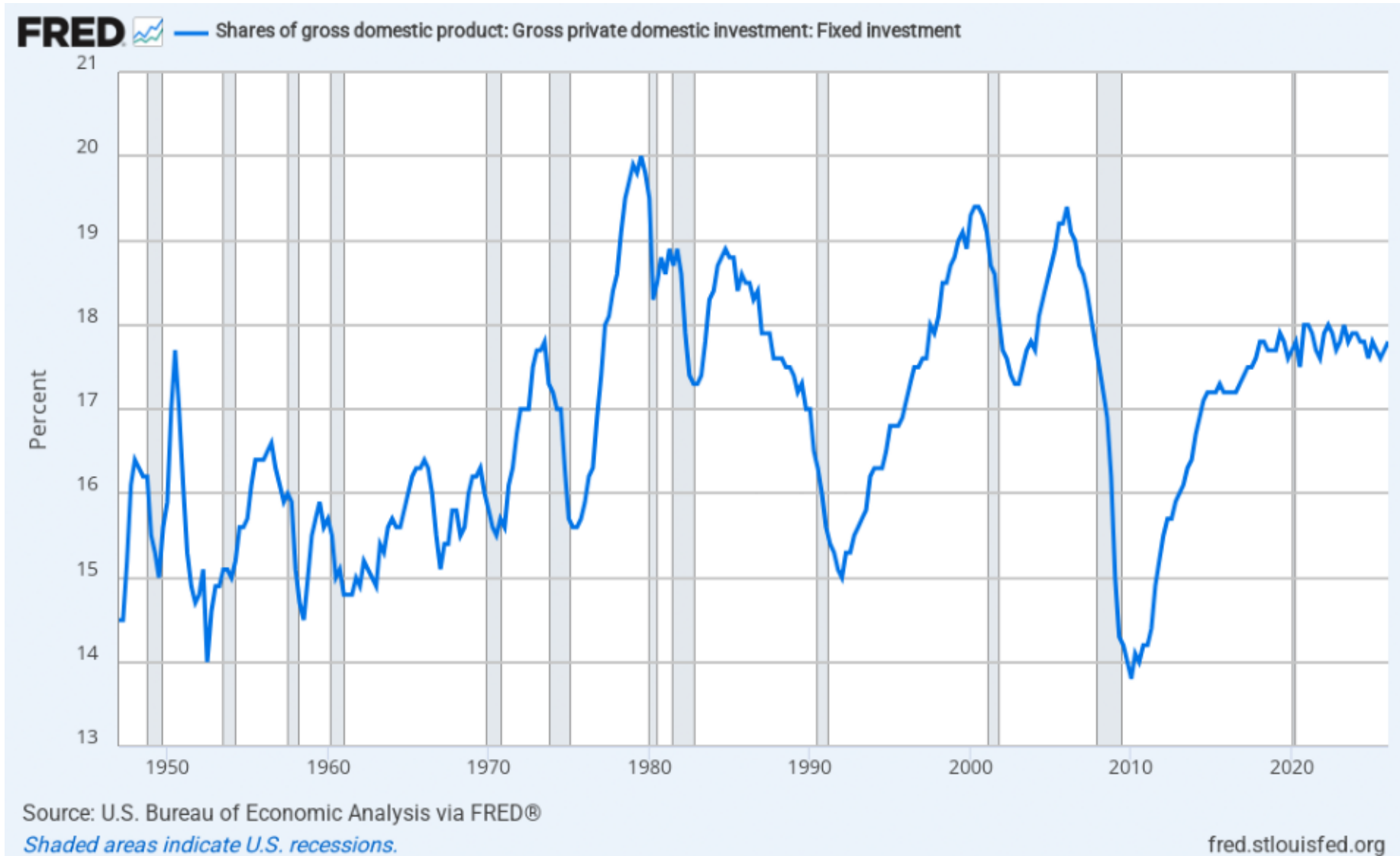
Part II — Building the American Growth Machine

The Golden Spike: Promontory Summit, Utah, May 10, 1869



Source: Andrew J. Russell, "East and West Shaking Hands at the Laying of the Last Rail" (1869). Public domain, via Wikimedia Commons. The transcontinental railroad was completed in Utah.

U.S. fixed private investment as a share of GDP



Wealth-to-income ratios, 1700-present

& non-profit sectors).

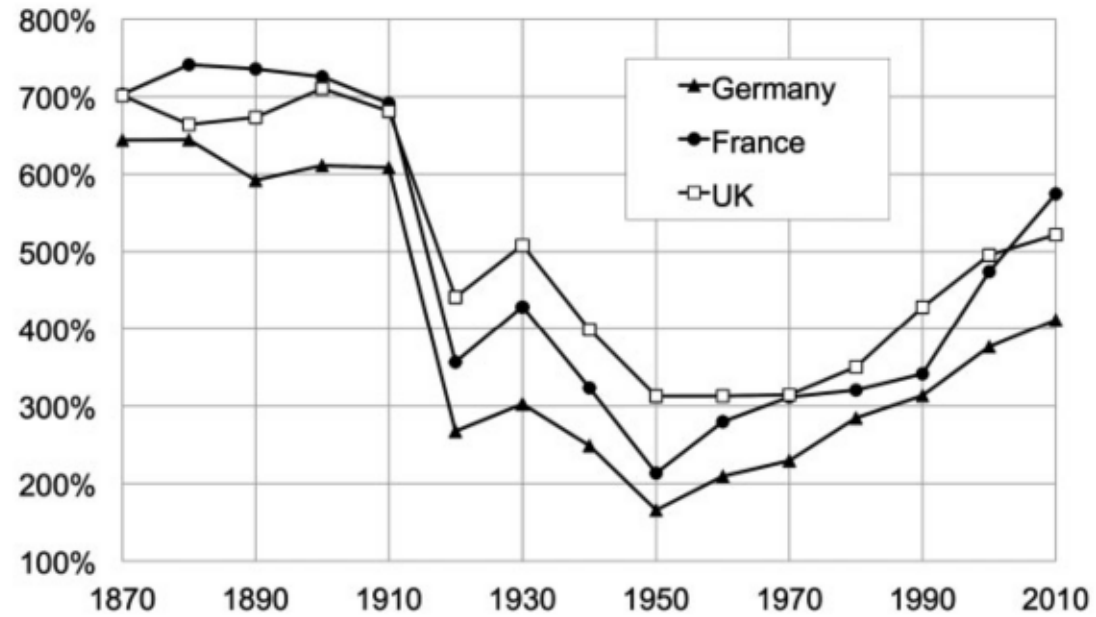


FIGURE II

Private Wealth-National Income Ratios in Europe, 1870–2010

Authors' computations using country national accounts. Private wealth = non-financial assets + financial assets – financial liabilities (household & non-profit sectors). Data are decennial averages (1910–1913 averages for 1910).